



DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF OF NAVAL OPERATIONS
2000 NAVY PENTAGON
WASHINGTON DC 20350-2000

OPNAVINST 1040.11G
N1
5 Mar 2026

OPNAV INSTRUCTION 1040.11G

From: Chief of Naval Operations

Subj: NAVY ENLISTED RETENTION AND CAREER DEVELOPMENT PROGRAM

Ref: (a) NAVPERS 15878N
(b) OPNAV N1 ltr 1000 Ser N1/121079 of 23 Dec 13 (NOTAL)
(c) DTFM ltr 5311 Ser N12/138 of 5 Sep 25 (NOTAL)
(d) OPNAVINST 1900.2D
(e) BUPERSINST 1001.39F
(f) OPNAVINST 3120.32D

1. Purpose

a. To provide guidance for the managing and operating of the Navy Enlisted Retention and Career Development Program (CDP), per references (a) through (f).

b. This revision incorporates process changes per reference (a). This instruction is a complete revision and should be reviewed in its entirety.

2. Cancellation. OPNAVINST 1040.11F.

3. Scope and Applicability. The instruction applies to all commands with enlisted personnel and mandates adherence to the policies and procedures for Navy Enlisted Retention and CDP.

4. Discussion. The Navy Enlisted Retention and CDP aims to improve Sailors ability to achieve their professional goals and encourage them to remain on Active Duty or transition to the Navy Reserve. Active chain of command involvement is crucial for a successful CDP. This instruction serves as guidance for all Navy commands. Individual command instructions are not required.

5. Objectives. The Navy Enlisted Retention and CDP strengthens policies and programs to:

- a. Retain high-quality Sailors in appropriate skill sets.
- b. Provide Sailors and their families with the necessary guidance for informed career decisions.
- c. Encourage all separating personnel to consider affiliating in the Navy Reserve.

- d. Ensure all separating personnel receive required transition counseling.
 - e. Promote collaboration between the command leadership, Command Career Counselor (CCC) and Unit Career Counselor (UCC) in executing the command's retention and CDP.
6. Feedback. Continuous feedback from Sailors and their families is essential to the CDP. Sailors are encouraged to provide feedback to Senior Navy leadership through Commander, Navy Personnel Command (COMNAVPERSCOM) by participating in Navy personnel surveys, quick polls, other surveys or by contacting the COMNAVPERSCOM MyNavy Career Center at askmncc@navy.mil or calling 1-833-330-MNCC (1-833-330-6622).
7. Policy. To optimize the Navy Enlisted Retention and CDP, all career counselors will receive the necessary equipment, training, resources and staffing to fulfill their responsibilities.
8. Responsibilities
- a. Deputy Chief of Naval Operations, Personnel, Manpower and Training (CNO N1):
 - (1) Oversees the Navy Enlisted Retention and CDP for all commands.
 - (2) Publishes annual all Navy Retention Excellence Award (REA) Best in Class (BIC) reenlistment benchmarks and criteria via naval administrative message.
 - b. Director, Military Personnel, Plans and Policy (OPNAV N13):
 - (1) Serves as the central point of contact for Navy wide enlisted retention policy and CDP guidelines, ensuring standardization throughout the Navy.
 - (2) Oversees community health, including advancement and retention.
 - c. Director, Head, Enlisted Force Plans Policy Branch (OPNAV N132):
 - (1) Serves as the central point of contact for all Navy enlisted retention policy development and execution, collaborating with echelon 1 and 2 commands to establish CDP guidelines, ensuring standardization.
 - (2) Assesses the impact of personnel policies, analyzes problem areas, formulates recommendations with echelon 1 and 2 career counselors for corrective action and proposes changes to improve retention (e.g., re-enlistment and attrition).
 - d. Deputy Chief of Naval Personnel (DEPCHNAVPERS):
 - (1) Serves as the Navy counselor (NC) community advisor for both Active and Reserve Components, per reference (b).

(2) Identifies Fleet Counselor positions as nominative NC requisitions to ensure experienced senior NCs are placed in these positions, per reference (c).

(3) Ensures commands are properly staffed with NCs or Navy enlisted classification (NEC) 806R or 807R personnel per reference (a).

e. Fleet Master Chief Petty Officer (CNO N1FLT):

(1) Acts as the principal enlisted advisor to the CNO N1 on Sailor advocacy policies and issues.

(2) Ensures that Command Senior Enlisted Leaders (CSEL) are trained and understand their roles in supporting Sailorization programs per references (a) through (f).

f. Bureau of Naval Personnel Military Community Management (BUPERS-3):

(1) Provides technical support to OPNAV N13 and OPNAV N132 in developing reenlistment policy, CDPs and community management.

(2) Assists DEPCHNAVPERs in executing their responsibilities as NC community advisor and acts as the technical advisor for the NCs, NEC 806R and NEC 807R communities in line with reference (b).

(3) Provides monthly NC community health report to echelon 1 and 2 commanders via Fleet and Force Career Counselors.

(4) Provides OPNAV N132 and echelon 2 commanders status of training, programs, policies and planning along with reenlistment and attrition matters.

(5) Monitors and reports Navy reenlistment and attrition trends. Analyzes and maintains reenlistment and attrition data for echelon 1 and 2 commanders.

(6) Manages Career Information Management System (CIMS) and the Navy Retention Monitoring System (NRMS) CDP and applicable information technology systems.

(7) Maintains career development information on the MyNavy HR website.

(8) Completes annual content review of the Navy Counselor (Counselor) (NCC) Learning and Development Roadmap (LADR).

(9) Ensures Commander, Naval Education and Training Command (NETC) provides the required updates for the Career Development Training Course (CDTC) and First Term Success Workshop (FTSW).

(10) Ensures Commander, Navy Reserve Forces Command (COMNAVRESFORCOM) completes the annual update for the Reserve Affiliation Success Workshop (RASW).

(11) Provides up to date career development training through Fleet engagement team (FET) visits to Fleet concentration areas and other areas as requested. Training should include the latest force management initiatives and career development tools to local command leadership.

(12) Provides career development resources for all NCs including NC Training and Administration of the Reserve (NC TAR) assigned to echelon 1, 2 and 3 commands as requested. Training will include, but is not limited to:

- (a) CIMS.
- (b) NRMS.
- (c) CIMS Analytics.
- (d) Career Waypoints (C-WAY).
- (e) Conducting and reporting of the Career Information Program Review (CIPR).
- (f) Enlisted community manager roles and responsibilities.
- (g) Transition Assistance Program (TAP) reporting and Defense Manpower Data Center (DMDC) submissions.
- (h) MyNavy Assignments (MNA) conversion process.

g. Echelon 2 Commands:

(1) Oversee the Navy Enlisted Retention and CDP for echelon 3 and direct reporting commands.

(a) Ensure all commands utilize CIMS to manage and document the career development of their Sailors.

(b) Conduct in person CIPRs utilizing NAVPERS 1040/2 or NAVRES 1040/1 as applicable and report findings to appointed leadership:

- 1. Annually.
- 2. As requested by command leadership.

3. As requested by Type Commanders (TYCOM) or Immediate Superiors in Command (ISIC) NCs.

(2) Liaise with OPNAV N132 and BUPERS-3 on retention and career development, providing feedback on policy impacts.

(3) Provide REA BIC criteria input to OPNAV N132.

(4) Monitor manning requirements for NCs, NEC 806R and NEC 807R personnel.

(5) Liaise with BUPERS-3, COMNAVPERSCOM Career Management Department (PERS-4) and Navy region commanders for Career Development Symposiums (CDS) and FET visits.

(6) Provide recommendations to BUPERS-3 and NETC regarding CCC course (A-501-0011), FTSW, CDTC, and career development training products.

(7) Provide check-in brief for all NCs reporting to TYCOM and Regional Commands to include, but not be limited to:

(a) CIMS Analytics.

(b) TAP reporting and DMDC submissions.

(c) C-WAY requirements.

(d) MNA.

(e) Initial-tour feedback.

(f) Conducting CIPRs.

(8) Complete annual content review of the NCC LADR.

h. COMNAVRESFOR:

(1) Establishes policies for Navy Reserve enlisted retention and career development.

(2) Releases annual Reserve Personnel Program Excellence Award (RPPEA) criteria within 90 days of the new fiscal year.

(3) Completes annual review of content and administration of RASW.

- (4) Completes annual review of content of the Reserve LADR.
- (5) Provides recommendations to BUPERS-3 and Navy Reserve Professional Development Center regarding career development related training products and Reserve career information course (R-501-0005).
- (6) Conducts quarterly career development training for echelon 3 and 4 CCCs.
- (7) Ensures an internal CIPR or baseline review is conducted for all newly reporting NCs, 806R and 807R NECs within 90 days of reporting.
- (8) Assists echelon 2 commanders with the coordination and hosting of CDS and FET visits with BUPERS-3, PERS-4 and Navy region commanders.
- i. TYCOM, Regional Commanders and ISIC:
 - (1) Oversee CDP for all echelon 4 and direct reporting commands:
 - (2) Utilize CIMS analytics to monitor the CDP of subordinate and supported commands.
 - (3) Conduct an in person annual CIPR as required utilizing NAVPERS 1040/2 or NAVRES 1040/1.
 - (4) ISIC NCs will assist the Regional CCC in the coordination and hosting of CDS and FET visits with BUPERS-3, PERS-4, echelon 2 and Regional Commanders.
 - (5) Monitor manning requirements for NCs, NEC 806R and 807R personnel.
 - (6) TYCOM NCs will provide check-in brief for all reporting ISIC NCs within 60 days.
 - (7) Conduct quarterly career counselor training with ISICs. Subordinate ISICs must conduct monthly training with commands under their cognizance, ensure all CCCs attend, and invite command leadership.
 - (8) Monitor attendance and provide recommendations and feedback concerning TAP workshops in line with reference (d).
 - (9) Ensure all initial tour counselors (graduates of CCC course (A-501-0011) or Reserve career information course (R-501-0005) provide feedback on performance, preparedness and counselor knowledge using NAVPERS 1040/3, Career Counselor Initial Tour Feedback, to the applicable ISIC or TYCOM CCC for further forwarding to the applicable NC course manager as outlined per reference (a).

(10) Review and analyze monthly reenlistment, attrition statistics and CDP information of subordinate and supported commands.

(11) Brief prospective command leadership on CDPs and policies.

(12) Navy Reserve Activities must provide administrative assistance to supported units for Navy Reserve programs in line with reference (e).

(13) Review command self-assessments completed by all newly reported NC, NC (TAR), NEC 806R CCCs and UCCs within 90 days of reporting.

(14) ISIC CCC provide monthly reports and brief monthly career information to their command leadership.

(15) TYCOM NCs provide quarterly reports to TYCOM leadership.

j. Commanding Officers (COs) and Officers in Charge:

(1) Exercise overall responsible for the command's CDP as outlined in reference (f).

(2) Establish and maintain a proactive retention and CDP as per this instruction.

(3) Ensure the CCC reports to the Executive Officer (XO) via the CSEL. The CSEL directly supervises and supports CCCs and UCCs in the performance of their duties.

(4) Ensure UCCs complete the CDTC-RC provided by the NRA CCC prior to designation (UCCs may attend Reserve career information course (R-501-0005) after completing six months as designated UCC) and that UCCs remain in the position for a minimum of two years if awarded the NEC 807R.

(5) Ensure full utilization of CIMS for documentation and reporting in Sailor career development.

(6) Ensure quarterly career development team meetings are conducted.

(a) Quarterly career development team meetings will include the command triad, CCC, department career counselors, department heads and department Leading Chief Petty Officers (LCPO).

(b) Career development team meetings and training agendas will consist of:

1. Review of retention and attrition statistics.

2. Discussion of Career Decisions for prospective loss Sailors.
3. Career development board completion rate by department and command overall numbers.
4. Discussion of Career Development concerns of specific Sailors as needed.
5. Discussion of the latest policy changes related to Career Development.
6. Review of Veterans Opportunity Workforce (VOW) command completion percentages.
7. Discussion of Sailors required to make a Montgomery GI Bill (MGIB) election decision.
8. Discussion of Sailors required to submit Selected Reserves (SELRES) application based on their Military Service Obligation (MSO).

(c) Review for Navy Reserve Component includes:

1. Expiration of Obligated Service.
 2. Age 60.
 3. MGIB –SELRES.
 4. Reserve Incentive Bonus eligibility and Prior Service Reenlistment Eligibility – Reserve.
 5. Review of Career Development Boards (CDB) completion percentages from the previous quarter.
 6. Review and discussion of all career development major concerns.
- (7) Utilize the CCC and UCC as the primary source of career information.
- (8) Ensure the CSEL chairs, monitors and participates in the command's CDB program, as required by reference (a).
- (9) Review CDB minutes and endorse as appropriate.
- (10) Ensure all CDBs are documented in CIMS in a timely manner.

- (11) Encourage conversion from overmanned to undermanned ratings.
 - (12) Ensure internal self-assessment is conducted within 90 days of a new CCC reporting aboard using reference (a).
 - (13) Establish the annual budget for training.
 - (14) Provide feedback on performance, preparedness and counselor knowledge on all initial tour CCC and UCC, using the initial tour feedback report in line with NAVPERS 1040/3.
 - (15) Ensure compliance with C-WAY utilizing NAVPERS 1040/4 during reporting career development board.
 - (16) Ensure the command triad reviews the monthly career information report.
 - (17) Ensure CIPR is requested as needed when CDP management requires TYCOM and ISIC-level assistance to properly execute.
 - (18) Ensure that the CCC has the highest level of internet access to accomplish mission requirements.
- k. XOs and Assistant Officer in Charge:
- (1) Ensure the CSEL supervises and supports the CCC and UCCs in the performance of their duties.
 - (2) Ensure CCC and UCC have access to a computer with the highest-level internet access necessary to accomplish mission requirements.
 - (3) Provide suitable office space and access to private counseling space.
 - (4) Utilize the CCC as the primary source for career development.
 - (5) Ensure the CSEL, CCC and UCC develop, maintain and supervise the career development team-training program. All unit, department and division career counselors must attend the CDTC within 180 days of designation.
 - (6) Ensure all department, division and unit career counselors are designated in writing and must remain in position for a period of 1 year.
 - (7) Ensure client-to-CDTC trained counselor ratio of no greater than 30 to 1.
 - (8) Ensure the CCC and UCC conduct annual internal CIPRs and are recommended to

conduct additional reviews when command triad leadership changes or when the command seeks assistance from their TYCOM, ISIC or RC as outlined in reference (a).

(9) Ensure all Sailors in pay grades E-1 through E-4 attend FTSW within 180 days of reporting and ensure all newly affiliated Navy Reserve Sailors attend RASW during initial assignment.

(10) Ensure all eligible transitioning Sailors receive counseling on the benefits of Navy Reserve affiliation.

(11) Ensure compliance with C-WAY.

(12) Ensure the requirement for a CIPR is communicated to CO or Officer in Charge and requested from the TYCOM or ISIC CCC.

1. CSELs:

(1) Exercise direct responsibility for the commands CDP and supervises and supports CCC and UCC in the performance of their duties.

(2) Chair command level CDBs or designate an alternate LCPO per reference (a).

(3) Ensure department LCPO chairs department level CDBs per reference (a).

(4) Ensure CDBs are conducted and documented in CIMS per reference (a).

(a) Command level CDBs will include CCC and be augmented by department LCPO, the educational services officer (ESO), personnel and pay specialist, mentor and various other department career development board members as applicable.

(b) Department level CDBs will include department LCPOs or alternate division chief petty officers, leading petty officers, department career counselors and be augmented by ESOs, personnel and pay specialists and mentors as applicable.

(5) Participate in career development team meetings as outlined in reference (a).

(6) Provide feedback within 12-months on performance, preparedness and counselor knowledge on all initial tour counselors using the NAVPERS 1040/3 in line with reference (a) to the TYCOM or ISIC.

(7) Coordinate training as needed for the chief petty officer mess and wardroom on CDPs in line with reference (a).

m. CCCs and UCCs:

(1) Be responsible to the CO and reports directly to the XO via the CSEL as the primary source for career development.

(2) Manage the CDP per reference (a) and current guidance.

(3) Complete required training (CCC Course (A-501-0011), Reserve career information course (R-501-0005), CDTC or CDTC-RC).

(4) Conduct CDTCs to maintain training levels at 100 percent for all department and division career counselors.

(5) Conduct monthly career development team training.

(6) CCCs must ensure CDBs are completed per reference (a).

(7) Prepare a monthly report to include but not limited to items listed from subparagraphs 8k(7)(a) through 8k(7)(k).

(a) Career development board minutes.

(b) C-WAY results.

(c) Command retention and attrition statistics.

(d) Scheduled reenlistments.

(e) 15-month prior to End of Active Obligated Service (EAOS), Soft End of Active Obligated Service (SEAOS) and Projected Rotation Date (PRD) personnel losses to include MNA results.

(f) 24-month high year tenure list.

(g) TAP and VOW Act compliance.

(h) Career development training minutes and muster sheet.

(i) Review of Sailors who must elect MGIB.

(j) Blended Retirement System Continuation Pay eligibility list.

(k) Monthly review of Sailors under 4/2/2 military service obligation.

(8) Ensure all Sailors in pay grades E-1 through E-4 attend FTSW within 180 days of reporting and ensure all newly affiliated Reserve Sailors attend RASW during initial assignment, in line with reference (a). Naval Reserve Activities (NRA) must conduct the RASW for supported units in conjunction with command indoctrination.

(9) Conduct an annual review of each department's CDP using NAVPERS 1040/2 and provide written feedback to the respective department's chain of command.

(10) Ensure the command triad is aware of CDP areas of concern, requiring TYCOM or ISIC-level support.

(11) Ensure all transitioning Sailors receive formal initial and pre-separation counseling using the online DD Form 2648, Service Member Pre-Separation Transition Counseling and Career Readiness Standards eForm for Service Members Separating, Retiring, Released from Active Duty (REFRAD), Selected Reserves on Active Duty (Active Duty for Operational Support, mobilization, etc) as required by reference (d).

(12) Ensure every transitioning Sailor is provided assistance with developing an individual transition plan, if requested, in line with reference (d).

(13) Coordinate TAP quotas for Sailors who are separating, transferring to Fleet Reserve or retiring.

(14) Conduct CIPR self-assessment 14 days prior to the command's TYCOM or ISIC CIPR and provide results to Chain of Command with a Plan of Action and Milestone.

n. Departmental Career Counselor:

(1) Be responsible to the Department Head and reports directly to the Department Leading Chief Petty Officer (DLCPO) as the primary source for career development.

(2) Assign trained divisional counselors for every 30 Sailors in the department.

(3) Successfully complete CDTC within 6 months from designation date along with their divisional career counselors.

(4) Ensure departmental CDBs are conducted per reference (a).

(5) Prepare and provide monthly career development report to the department head via DLCPO to include but not limited to:

(a) CDB minutes.

- (b) Scheduled departmental reenlistments.
- (c) 15-month prior to EAOS, SEAOS and PRD personnel losses to include MNA results.
- (d) 24-month high year tenure list.
- (6) Utilize a tickler and tracking system for required CDB and Professional Apprenticeship Career Track applications.
- (7) Obtain access to CIMS and C-WAY.
- (8) Assist CCC in facilitating CDTC and FTSW.
- (9) Attend monthly CDT training.

9. Records Management

a. Records created as a result of this instruction, regardless of format or media, must be maintained and dispositioned per the records disposition schedules found on Directives and Records Management Division portal page at

<https://portal.secnav.navy.mil/orgs/DUSNM/DONAA/DRM/Records-and-Information-Management/Approved%20Record%20Schedules/Forms/AllItems.aspx>.

b. For questions, concerning the management of records related to this instruction or the records disposition schedules, please contact the local records manager or the OPNAV Records Management Program (DNS-16).

10. Review and Effective Date. Per OPNAVINST 5215.17A, CNO N1 will review this instruction annually around the anniversary of its issuance date to ensure applicability, currency and consistency with Federal, Department of Defense, Secretary of the Navy and Navy policy and statutory authority using OPNAV 5215/40 Review of Instruction. This instruction will be in effect for 10 years, unless revised or cancelled in the interim and will be reissued by the 10-year anniversary date if it is still required, unless it meets one of the exceptions in OPNAVINST 5215.17A, paragraph 9. Otherwise, if the instruction is no longer required, it will be processed for cancellation as soon as the need for cancellation is known following the guidance in OPNAV Manual 5215.1 of May 2016.

11. Reports and Forms

a. The reporting requirements contained in this instruction are exempt from reports control, per SECNAV Manual 5214.1.

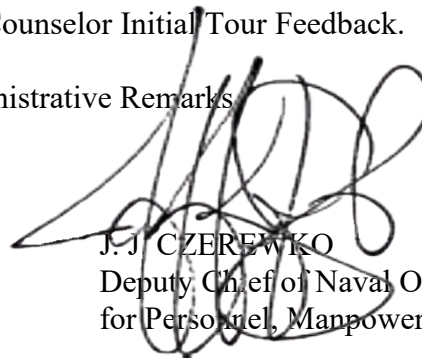
b. The following form is available on the Executive Services Directorate website at <https://www.esd.whs.mil/Directives/forms> and the DMDC website <https://www.dodtap.mil/>: DD Form 2648, Service Member Pre-Separation/Transition Counseling and Career Readiness Standards Eform for Service Members Separating, Retiring, REFRAD.

c. The forms listed in subparagraphs 11c(1) through 11c(3) are available on Naval Forms Online at <https://forms.documentservices.dla.mil/order/>:

(1) NAVPERS 1040/2, Career Information Program Review.

(2) NAVPERS 1040/3, Career Counselor Initial Tour Feedback.

(3) NAVPERS 1070/613, Administrative Remarks



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Releasability and distribution:

This instruction is cleared for public release and is available electronically only via DON Issuances website, <https://www.secnav.navy.mil/doni/default.aspx>.